ACC
ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	27th Commission Meeting
DATE:	10 June, ~~2023~~ 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	Druk Dradhir Khang

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSIONS	DECISIONS
1	**Follow-up update on the staff meeting & proposed workshop for the 22nd International Anti-Corruption Conference (IACC) - PPD** a) *Transparency International had communicated its regrets for not considering Bhutan's proposal to conduct a workshop at the sidelines of 22nd IACC in Punta Cana, Dominican Republic. It was noted that IACC received an overwhelming number of workshop proposals and faced limited capacity to accommodate all submissions. The PPD apprised that the absence of an identified resource person for the proposed session may have affected consideration of ACC's proposal.* b) *As a follow-up of the 26th Commission meeting, the proposed agenda for the First Staff meeting was reviewed.*	a) The Commission directed the PPD to continue following up on opportunities for ACC's participation in the 22nd IACC as a participant, including registration requirements. b) The meeting endorsed the proposed agenda and format for the First Staff Meeting on 17 July 2026. The PPD was directed the following: - prepare broad priorities areas for the Commission and present for review, before the staff meeting; - implement *PechaKucha* presentation format and communicate the guidelines to all Department/Division/ROs; - rotate the sequence of department updates/presentations for such meetings hereafter; - use *Slido* to facilitate open discussion, with facilitator moderating comments/ questions/feedback; - venue to be at the *Choesham*, subject to completion of the renovation works, with a modest in-house *tendrel*. If not, RITH will be explored. The meeting noted that the proposal to invite the official from the Indian Embassy (being the development partner) for the inauguration of *Choesham* may not be appropriate. We may explore for other occasions at a later date.
2	Update on legal workshop held to finalize Guidelines on evidence vetting, evidence matrix, and framing of charges from 18 - 24 May, 2026 – LD	Directed LD to circulate the drafts through email to the Commission, together with a presentation highlighting their key features in the Commission meeting.

	The three legal documents prepared during the workshop, namely Guide on evidence vetting; Element to evidence/proof matrix of corruption offences; and Guide to draft probable charges and a charge sheet, was apprised.	
3	Update on CoRE Network workshop held from 25 – 30 May, 2026 – DoI, DARE, LD & PPD *CoRE Network Workshop was attended by 17 participants, including 10 officials from RBP, DLO, MoHA, DRC, MoF, and RMA. The workshop developed several operational documents, including SOP for Intelligence Sharing; Data Reference Model; Intelligence Classification and Handling Guideline; Non-Disclosure Agreement; Annual Work Plan; Intelligence Request and Sharing Form as well as platform, among others covering whole intelligence life cycle. The ACC also demonstrated its online case management system and institutional practices relating to surveillance, intelligence handling, and data analysis & management. It was reported that other participants appreciated the ACC's system and acknowledged its potential to enhance intelligence coordination and collaboration across agencies. At the same time, they highlighted existing operational challenges, particularly limitations in their technical capacity and quality data, underscoring the value of the CoRE Network in addressing these gaps.* *In keeping with these, the workshop proposed agenda for the first Governing Committee Meeting to focus on i) mobilizing resources for CoRE Network activities, ii) expanding access to data repositories maintained by agencies such as BICMA, the Department of Immigration, and the Department of Trade, and iii) promoting the sharing*	The Commission noted that while the ACC will take the lead in operationalizing and coordinating the CoRE Network during its initial years, member agencies should progressively assume equal ownership and responsibility, including contributing to the financing and sustainability of network activities. The Commission further agreed, in principle, that the Intelligence Request and Sharing Platform be hosted by the ACC to facilitate secure and coordinated information exchange among member agencies. Further, on the Annual Work Plan for July 2026 – June 2027, the Commission directed that it should prioritize practical and results-oriented initiatives, including: - maximizing the use of the CoRE Network for intelligence generation and data sharing on matters such as Missing Persons; and - leveraging the Network during electoral processes for timely intelligence and information sharing to Election Commission of Bhutan (ECB). DoI, DARE, LD & PPD to share the drafts for Commission's review.

	of technical expertise and capacity development programmes among member agencies.	
5	Update on Asia Regional Expert Meeting on Measuring the Effectiveness of Anti-Corruption Agencies (ACAs) to be held in Thimphu from 30 June – 2 July 2026 – PPD *The PPD apprised on the preparations for hosting the regional event and presented the proposed programme and logistical arrangements.* *It was noted that a separate notesheet seeking administrative approval for the event will be prepared and submitted for approval.*	The Commission directed the following: i) **Programme and Technical Sessions:** - PPD to coordinate with Heads of Departments/Divisions to nominate presenters and ensure timely preparation of presentations. - Invite ECB to nominate a representative to deliver a session on 'political financing'. - Explore inviting resource person/s from the Special Investigation Service of Lithuania. - Session moderators to be briefed to facilitate discussions effectively while keeping their interventions concise. - No separate bilateral meetings to be proposed as a host. However, requests from delegates may be accommodated where feasible. - PPD to prepare a brief note to be submitted to *Gokha* immediately within the current or following week, with the list of participants. - In addition to the Management and officials directly involved in the event, as many ACC staff as practicable to attend as observers for learning and exposure, subject to availability and nomination by respective Heads. ii) **Dinner program:** - Terma Linca, particularly its riverside dining area, to be explored for the welcome dinner, with Postcard Dewa as an alternative option. - The DG, Department of Multilateral Affairs, to be included in the lists of invitees for the opening programme and the welcome dinner. - A seating plan for the official dinner to be prepared once the final participant list is confirmed. iii) **Logistics and coordination:** - Delegates to be taken on a guided visit to selected areas of the ACC office, followed by tea. - The cultural programme includes a visit to Chimi Lhakhang, besides Punakha Dzong on 2nd July. - Where requested, arrangements may be made to facilitate extended stays in Bhutan for the delegates. - PPD to lead the overall coordination and organization of the event and engage relevant Divisions as necessary, including engaging young officials as liaison officers to support delegates.

		- Necessary arrangements to be made in advance for visa facilitation and waivers of monument entry fees, where applicable. - PPD to propose suitable event souvenirs for the Commission's consideration.
6	**Apprise on the follow-up of the ADB/OECD Anti-Corruption Initiative – PPD** *The key outcomes and follow-up actions arising from the ACC's participation in the event, particularly on the bilateral meetings as follows, were reviewed:* ***Anti-Corruption Agency, Uzbekistan*** - *Explore areas of cooperation with ACA of Uzbekistan in the FY 2026-2027, based on its proposal to sign MoU, including possibility to learn more on its annual award programs.* ***OECD*** - *PPD to review the PII and present a proposal to the Commission.* - *PPD to review the possibility to participate in BIRS at a later stage of the DAMSTI BIZ.* ***Special Investigation Service (STT) of the Republic of Lithuania*** - *Submit a TAIEX proposal to the Delegation of the EU to India and Bhutan for a study visit to Vilnius covering intelligence, preventive and investigative techniques, inter-agency cooperation mechanisms for whole of government integrity management.* ***ADB*** - *Prepare a concept paper for targeted training in the next financial year for the judiciary, law enforcement agencies, regulatory authorities, investigators, and prevention officers.* - *Include a request for technical assistance (TA) to review and recommend reforms in law*	The Commission decided that no immediate action is required on the proposed MoU with ACA of Uzbekistan. The matter may be pursued if the ACA follows up on its proposal. Directed PPD to review both Business Integrity Regional Snapshot (BIRS) and Public Integrity Indicators (PII) initiative, and submit proposals to the Commission for consideration and further action. With regard to TAIEX cooperation with the STT of Lithuania, directed PPD to share the draft with the STT and the Delegation of the EU in New Delhi for comments and improvement, targeting it to be submitted by Monday, 15 June. On the proposed collaboration with ADB, the Commission directed PPD to prepare the capacity-building proposal and concept paper for its review. With regard to the request for TA, PPD was further directed to assess the need for such assistance in light of previous TA provided for systems reviews in customs and related areas, including the extent to which the resulting recommendations had been implemented. The Commission also emphasized that any future TA or capacity-building support should primarily benefit the ACC, with the ACC serving as the principal beneficiary. The Commission directed the Prevention Division to expedite the pilot testing of DAMTSI BIZ, while simultaneously sharing the draft with CAC and BIG.

	enforcement and regulatory agencies. ***Collective Action Against Corruption, Thailand (Thai CAC) & Basel Institute on Governance (BIG)*** - *PPD & PD of DoPE to share the revised draft of DAMTSI BIZ with CAC of Thailand and BIG for comments/improvement.* - *PD to review the OECD Toolkit for raising awareness and preventing corruption in SMEs and present to the Commission to improve DAMTSI BIZ.*	
7	Present on Public Integrity Indicator (PII) of OECD – PPD *PPD presented an overview of the OECD PII, a benchmarking framework that assesses the effectiveness of national public integrity systems across key dimensions such as strategic frameworks, risk management, accountability, justice and disciplinary systems, oversight and control, and meritocracy in the public sector.* *The Commission noted that the PII findings contribute to the OECD's biennial Anti-Corruption and Integrity Outlook, providing internationally comparable evidence to inform policy reforms. Further noted that no South Asian country has participated in the assessment to date, presenting an opportunity for Bhutan to demonstrate its public integrity efforts and gain international visibility while identifying areas for improvement.*	The Commission acknowledged the potential value of participating in the OECD PII, particularly the opportunity for Bhutan to be featured in OECD flagship publications, including the *Anti-Corruption and Integrity Outlook.* The Commission directed PPD to obtain and review the complete OECD PII questionnaire and assessment framework and undertake a detailed assessment of Bhutan's readiness, particularly in relation to the datasets on Strategy, Risk, Accountability, and Justice. The review should assess the availability of required data, identify relevant respondent agencies and any information gaps, and submit findings and recommendations to the Commission. The Commission emphasized that any identified gaps will not, in themselves, preclude Bhutan's participation in the initiative but will instead inform subsequent engagement with relevant stakeholders, including the Hon'ble Prime Minister where necessary, and support evidence-based policy interventions. The submission of Expression of Interest to the OECD will follow this detailed review.

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**